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AUGUST 17, 2026
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AFP

ISRAELI STRIKES KILL 11 IN SOUTH LEBANON

First aid responders and residents rush to the site of an Israeli airstrike that targeted the southern Lebanese village of Deir Al Zahrani on Saturday. Lebanon said Israeli strikes on the south killed 11 people in the deadliest attacks since a deal was reached in June aimed at ending hostilities. Israel said it carried out retaliatory strikes against Hezbollah but Lebanon's Prime Minister Nawaf Salam said seven people killed in one of the strikes were not 'military targets' and urged Israel to halt an 'extremely dangerous' escalation. **SEE ALSO P7**

UAE ports expand east coast capacity, alternative trade routes

AD Ports Group, DP World broaden links; Khorfakkan eyes 10m containers

DUBAI
BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

UAE ports are expanding east coast capacity and alternative trade links, with AD Ports Group, Khorfakkan Port and DP World advancing projects and routes designed to strengthen cargo movement and supply chain resilience.

AD Ports Group said it ramped up alternative multimodal trade routes during Q2 2026 under the UAE's National Programme to Strengthen Supply Chain Resilience, following disruption around the Strait of Hormuz.

Cargo operations and feeder services were rerouted to Fujairah Terminals and Khorfakkan Port on the Gulf of Oman. The Group deployed 27 container vessels and five bulk vessels across alternative shipping cor-

AD Ports Group said it ramped up alternative multimodal trade routes during Q2 2026 under the UAE's National Programme to Strengthen Supply Chain Resilience.

ridors linking India, Pakistan, Oman, Red Sea ports and the Upper Arabian Gulf.

More road, rail and air links

It also added 400 trucks, increased Etihad Rail service frequency and introduced air cargo solutions for critical commodities including food and pharmaceuticals, using six chartered aircraft to date. Warehousing and storage capacity currently exceeds 54,000 square metres, with further dedicated capacity planned by year-end.

Khorfakkan Port is also being positioned for higher capacity. The Sharjah Ports, Customs and Free Zones Authority said expansion plans aim to increase

handling capacity to 5 million containers annually, with a longer-term ambition to reach 10 million.

Located on the Gulf of Oman, the port has deep-water berths and high-efficiency ship-to-shore cranes capable of accommodating the world's largest container vessels. Sharjah's wider network also connects Khorfakkan with Khalid Port and Hamriyah Port, alongside logistics complexes in Al Sajaa and Al Dhaid, border crossings and trade corridors.

Fujairah capacity expands

In July, DP World reached an agreement in principle with Fujairah Ports Authority under a 50-year concession to develop Al Rugaylat container and multi-purpose terminal and Dibba General Cargo terminal. Al Rugaylat is designed to handle up to 2.5 million TEUs annually, 1.7 million tonnes of general cargo and 190,000 Car Equivalent Units, while Dibba will add up to 3.6 million tonnes of annual general cargo capacity. **SEE ALSO P-1**

Dubai among top-10 cities globally for tourist appeal

Ranks as region's most attractive city

DUBAI
Gulf News Report

Dubai has been ranked the most attractive tourist city in the Middle East and 10th worldwide in a 2026 global index that uses online conversations to measure how travellers perceive destinations.

The Yanolja Attractiveness Index assessed 261 cities using online data and sentiment analysis, examining what travellers said about destinations rather than focusing solely on traditional measures such as infrastructure and tour-

ism policy. The research analysed data in 14 languages from June 2025 to May 2026.

Ahead of major cities

Dubai's 10th-place finish put it ahead of destinations including Tokyo, Yokohama, Singapore, Chicago and Miami, according to the ranking.

Osaka took first place in the attractiveness ranking, followed by Kyoto, with New York third and Seoul fourth. Paris placed fifth, followed by London in sixth, Rome seventh, Okinawa eighth and Bangkok ninth.

UAE STANDS FIRM ON STRAIT OF HORMUZ NAVIGATION RIGHTS

Gargash: Adnoc tanker attacks won't deter balanced approach

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

The UAE will safeguard its right to freedom of navigation through the Strait of Hormuz, defend its sovereignty and national interests, while continuing to prioritise dialogue and diplomatic solutions, Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, said on Saturday.

"The repeated targeting of Adnoc tankers will not deter the UAE from pursuing a balanced and rational policy based on three pillars: Deterrence, diplomacy and adherence to international law," Gargash said in a post on X.

Gulf unity key

Gargash also stressed the importance of Gulf unity, saying the UAE would make every effort to strengthen a common GCC position as a "key pillar for protecting the region's security and the interests of its countries in this ongoing crisis".

His comments followed an attack on an Adnoc vessel while it was passing through the Strait of Hormuz on Friday evening. No injuries were reported and the situation was brought under control, Adnoc said.

The UAE Ministry of Foreign Affairs said the Iranian attack constituted a flagrant breach of UN Security Council Resolution 2817, which affirmed the importance of freedom of navigation. It also condemned attacks on commercial vessels and the obstruction of international maritime routes.

Qatar denies claims

Meanwhile, Qatar has denied Iranian claims that it was holding three Iranian pilots whose aircraft went down during the war. Qatari foreign ministry spokesman Majed Al Ansari said the pilots had violated Qatari airspace in March and failed to respond to attempts to contact them. Search teams later found the remains of one pilot, he said, adding that Qatar had contacted Tehran to coordinate the handover of the remains.

"We categorically deny the claims circulating regarding the detention of Iranian pilots and are surprised by these misleading statements, amid the ongoing diplomatic efforts aimed at de-escalating tensions," Al Ansari said.

Iran said three Iranian pilots were captured alive by Qatari forces after ejecting from fighter jets during a combat mission in Qatar. — With AFP inputs **SEE ALSO P7**

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